

that includes all the changes implemented in the new snapshots.

Tumbleweed users have received more than seven snapshot updates recently. The project has received the latest versions of many widely-used applications.

Wipro joins block chain-centric Ethereum Alliance

Wipro has joined the Enterprise Ethereum Alliance (EEA) as a founding member. The EEA has been founded to promote, develop and implement enterprise grade Ethereum-based block chain applications.

Bengaluru-headquartered Wipro has been actively contributing to Ethereum. The open source platform features block chain-based computing with smart contract functionality. "We are excited to be a part of the founding team of the Enterprise Ethereum Alliance and contribute towards key aspects such as security, privacy and scalability as these will be the key determinants in accelerating block chain adoption



within enterprises," said Krishnakumar N. Menon, vice president of service transformation, Wipro Limited, in a joint statement.

Wipro's research and development on Ethereum will enable the development of block chain-based industry solutions such as Delivery versus Payments (DvP)

settlement for securities and capital markets, skip-trace consortia for banking, peer-to-peer (P2P) insurance for the sharing economy, and anti-counterfeit solutions for supply chain traceability.

"It is great to have Wipro as a founding member of the Enterprise Ethereum Alliance," said Marley Gray, principal block chain architect, Microsoft. In addition to the in-house developments, Ethereum is being used by Wipro client companies. The Indian IT giant has also established the Blockchain Innovation Lab as part of its Blockchain COE (Centre of Excellence) to support the advanced developments. The lab has been founded to build use-case specific block chain solutions.

Facebook's Oculus to plan its future around open source

Facebook-owned Oculus is set to shut down its virtual reality (VR) division, Oculus Story Studio. The new move is aimed to support developments around immersive experiences using the open source model.

Oculus' VP of content, Jason Rubin, has announced that the shutdown of its Story Studio is part of the shift that will result in the company offering support for external production. "After careful consideration, we have decided to shift our focus away from internal content creation to support more external production," Rubin writes in a blog post, adding, "As part of that shift, we will be winding down Story Studio."

Founded in 2014, Oculus Story Studio was designed to produce original cinematic content for the company. Initially, it brought out some VR shorts to persuade traditional filmmakers to enter the new world of entertainment. However, Oculus' team is now apparently seeking to build its future around open source.

Oculus will provide resources and programmes to help creators and third-party developers begin with their VR solutions. At the Oculus Connect developer conference in October, Facebook CEO Mark Zuckerberg highlighted the investment

Canonical, NetApp partner to deliver OpenStack-based solutions

Canonical has collaborated with NetApp to build unique open cloud solutions. The new partnership is set to leverage Ubuntu OpenStack and NetApp storage technologies, resulting in advanced cloud-centric developments.

The integration of NetApp with Ubuntu OpenStack will ease the efforts for Canonical's customers.

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OpenStack is currently being deployed as an IaaS (Infrastructure-as-a-Service). But the new collaborative services will integrate top-notch technologies like SolidFire and ONTAP into OpenStack releases.

"Together we are making it easier for enterprises to adopt OpenStack by taking the guesswork out of deploying and managing it," said John Zannos, vice president of the cloud platform and alliances, Canonical, in a statement.

Canonical has been largely focusing on the growth across the IoT (Internet of Things) and cloud areas. The latest deal enables it to accelerate its growth in the cloud space.

"We are excited to be a part of Canonical's OpenStack Technical Partner Program and are committed to the continued development of integrated cloud solutions to simplify IT delivery and rapidly advance new ideas from concept to production," said Anthony Lye, senior vice president of the cloud business unit, NetApp.

Based in San Francisco, USA, NetApp recently joined the Canonical Cloud Partner Program.

The Canonical-NetApp partnership will help organisations build automated, reliable and easily manageable hybrid as well as private clouds. Customers can simply deploy NetApp storage solutions and OpenStack using Juju. This efficiency will ensure organisations have to put minimal effort to deploy and manage OpenStack.

